

Moses Yang

Trudging Downstream

ten feet underwater
my feet are dredges
shoveling through the
cemented sediment

edging onwards but
my shoes in the sand
feeling
the sand in my shoes
teaming up with gravity
hoping to
swallow me whole

just take me in
embrace me
and pucker up
to kiss me
at least then
I won't be

alone

at 4 in the afternoon
my stomach is angry
punching out my chest
begging to
grapple through my mouth
looking to
shred with my canines
because I've neglected him

since 9 in the morning
I've been quivering in my

off-white white sneakers
crusted with dust from
three rains ago

stifled by the choice
of four different hoodies
and two different chinos

as if
I would be any cooler
would be any hotter
from the mixing and matching
of six different colors

my ego is scattered and shattered
diffracting in fireworks
through the running water
I can't admit
I'm scared to swim with my school

afraid of the long lines
waiting for food
spotting someone I know
but don't really *know*
an awkward wave
a whispered hello

They must not know my name,
so I wait until 4 before I eat my first meal.

I trudge alone
a fish out of water
as a fish inside water
fighting downstream
when the rest float up.